

Raghad Alsaka, Ph.D.

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ACADEMIC PROFILE

Ph.D. in Education with a specialization in Curriculum and Instruction and an emphasis on Educational Technology. My work focuses on teacher education, generative artificial intelligence in education, curriculum development, instructional strategies, and educational research. I have experience teaching and supporting preservice teachers at the University of Idaho, along with international K-12 English teaching experience in Jordan and Kuwait. My academic and professional interests include AI in education, instructional design, multilingual learners, children's literature, teacher preparation, and technology-supported learning.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Education, Curriculum and Instruction | University of Idaho

Moscow, Idaho, USA | Emphasis: Educational Technology | Completed: Spring 2026

- Dissertation: Generative AI in Graduate Education: Master's and Doctoral Students' Experiences and Academic Practices
- Chair: Dr. Janine Darragh
- Methodology: Qualitative phenomenological study using semi-structured interviews and reflexive thematic analysis

M.A. in Education, Educating Multilingual Learners | Arizona State University

Tempe, Arizona, USA | Completed: Fall 2021

B.A. in English Language and Literature | Al-Balqa Applied University

Jordan | Completed: Spring 2019

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS AND UNIVERSITY TEACHING

Graduate Teaching Assistant / Instructor | University of Idaho, Department of Curriculum and Instruction

Moscow, Idaho, USA | August 2023 - May 2026

- Taught and supported undergraduate and graduate students in curriculum planning, instructional methods, educational theory, and teacher preparation.
- Designed and facilitated learning activities, discussions, assignments, and assessments for preservice teachers.
- Supported students' academic writing, lesson planning, reflection, and professional growth.
- Provided feedback on course assignments, teaching reflections, literature circles, and classroom-based projects.
- Integrated educational technology and online tools to support student engagement and learning.
- Observed preservice teachers during field experiences and provided constructive feedback to support their instructional development and reflective practice.

Courses Taught

- EDCI 321 / ED 321: Literature for Children, University of Idaho
- EDCI 201 / EDCI 550: Contexts in Education, University of Idaho
- EDCI 409: Integrated Elementary Methods Practicum II, University of Idaho
- EDCI 301: Learning, Development, and Assessment, University of Idaho

RESEARCH AND SCHOLARLY PROJECTS

Dissertation Research | Generative AI in Graduate Education

University of Idaho | 2026

- Explored graduate students' lived experiences using generative AI in academic work.
- Examined how students use AI for brainstorming, summarizing, drafting, language refinement, and learning support.
- Investigated ethical concerns related to accuracy, privacy, academic integrity, institutional expectations, and overreliance.
- Used qualitative phenomenological methods, semi-structured interviews, and reflexive thematic analysis.

High-Impact Online Professional Learning Experiences for Teachers to Support Accelerated Learning for Students (CALM) |

University of Idaho

- Contributed to a professional learning project designed to support teachers through online professional development.
- Focused on research-based strategies, interactive tools, collaboration, and support for student learning.
- Supported qualitative data analysis by reviewing and refining AI-generated interview transcripts using Otter.ai, cleaning and organizing textual data, and preparing transcripts for thematic coding and interpretation.

PUBLICATIONS

Manuscripts Under Review

- Alsaka, R., Darragh, J., Wang, J., and Udekwa, L. (2026). Bridging practice and professional growth: Teachers' literacy perceptions and the potential of a literacy symposium. Manuscript under review at The WERA Educational Journal.
- Cheah, Y. H., Hsu, H.-P., Lu, J., & Alsaka, R. (2026). Talking to the machine: Pre-service teachers' prompting strategies and decision-making in using generative artificial intelligence. Manuscript under review at Australasian Journal of Educational Technology.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND PARTICIPATION

Selected Conference Presentations

- Preservice Teachers and Artificial Intelligence: Unpacking Their Conceptualizations, Use, and Justifications. Association for Educational Communications and Technology (AECT), 2025, Las Vegas.
- A Systematic Review of the Use of AI in Language Education: A Global Lens. Association for Educational Communications and Technology (AECT), 2025, Las Vegas.
- K-12 Teachers' Social Media Use for Professional Learning: A Cross-Cultural Comparison Study. Association for Educational Communications and Technology (AECT), 2025, Las Vegas.
- Kaleela: A User-Centered Approach to Arabic Language Learning Through Digital Innovation. Association for Educational Communications and Technology (AECT), 2025, Las Vegas.
- Preservice Teachers' Prompting Practices and Decision-Making in Using Generative Artificial Intelligence. American Educational Research Association (AERA), 2026, Los Angeles.

Conferences Attended

- Multi-Tiered System of Supports in education (MTSS), 2024, Pullman, Washington
- Association for Educational Communications and Technology (AECT), 2024, Kansas City

AWARDS AND HONORS

Best Paper Award | Instructional Technology SIG 52, American Educational Research Association (AERA)

2026, Los Angeles

- Awarded for the paper: Preservice Teachers’ Prompting Practices and Decision-Making in Using Generative Artificial Intelligence.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

English Teacher | Kingston School

Amman, Jordan | September 2020 - August 2021

- Taught English using the British curriculum for early elementary learners.
- Observed and evaluated students’ academic progress and social development.
- Revised lesson plans and instructional materials to support student-centered learning.
- Communicated with families and school staff to support students’ academic and behavioral development.

English Teacher | The English Playgroup and Primary Group Educational Company

Kuwait | September 2019 - August 2020

- Taught English and supported additional curriculum areas such as mathematics and personal, social, and emotional development.
- Developed quizzes, classroom activities, and instructional materials to evaluate student learning.
- Participated in after-school and seasonal programs.
- Communicated with parents through conferences and school activities.

Content Writer | Reach Immigration / Kaleela Project

Amman, Jordan | January 2019 - August 2019

- Wrote English-language articles for the Kaleela project, which supports Arabic learning for non-Arabic speakers.
- Researched topics related to language learning, culture, and education.
- Edited and proofread content for clarity, accuracy, and audience engagement.
- Conducted interviews with subject matter experts to develop article topics.

English Second Language Teacher | Arjan Gate Center

Amman, Jordan | 2017 - 2018

- Taught English to elementary-level learners through stories, songs, games, and interactive activities.
- Developed lessons to support grammar, reading, speaking, and conversational English.
- Integrated technology and student-centered activities to support language learning.
- Assisted with schedules, curriculum planning, and ESL activities.

TEACHING AREAS

Curriculum and instruction • Educational technology • AI in education • Teacher education • Children’s literature • Contexts of education • Instructional design • Multilingual education • English language teaching • Learning, development, and assessment • Classroom management and behavior support • Educational psychology

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Generative artificial intelligence in education • Educational technology and instructional design • Curriculum and instruction • Teacher education and preservice teacher preparation • AI literacy, prompting practices, and ethical AI use in education • Multilingual learners and English language education • Online and blended learning • Qualitative research, phenomenology, and thematic analysis

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- IRB Investigators and Student Researchers
- Safeguarding Young People, EduCare
- Fire Safety for International Schools, EduCare
- First Aid Essentials for International Schools, EduCare
- Leadership and Employment Program: Company Foundation and Work Communication Skills
- Growth Mindset Training, AlGhurair Foundation for Education
- English Conversation Course, University of Jordan Student Union
- Teaching training at AlAnjom School, Kindergarten level

SKILLS

Teaching and Curriculum

Curriculum development • Lesson planning • Teacher preparation • Classroom instruction • Student-centered learning • Assessment and evaluation • Children’s literature instruction • English language teaching • Multilingual learner support • Behavior management

Research and Academic Skills

Qualitative research • Semi-structured interviews • Thematic analysis • Literature review • Academic writing • APA 7 formatting • Technical writing • Research ethics and IRB procedures • Data organization and coding

Technology and Tools

Educational technology tools • Online and blended teaching tools • IBM SPSS Statistics • Computer literacy • Learning management systems • Generative AI tools for teaching and research support

LANGUAGES

Arabic: Native • English: Advanced / Professional proficiency